

Alex Eftychiou

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I start with the decision that needs to be made, not the research request. Across 12+ years in regulated financial services, public services and global technology, I have used research to frame complex product problems, challenge assumptions and shape direction across teams and programmes. I combine qualitative, quantitative and behavioural evidence to make uncertainty visible, strengthen decisions and build research capability that extends beyond individual studies. My background in cognitive engineering and human factors informs how I work with complex systems, comprehension and consequential decisions.

CORE EXPERTISE

Decision before method Clarify the decision, uncertainty and consequence before choosing the research.	Evidence in context Connect qualitative, quantitative and behavioural signals to separate what matters from what is merely visible.	Research that scales Build frameworks, governance and capability so better decisions continue beyond a single study.
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Interactive Investor | Senior User Researcher

March 2024 - Present

Research leadership across investment journeys and initiatives spanning Experience, Portfolio, Trading, Content and Research.

- Shape research roadmaps across multiple squads with Product, combining qualitative and quantitative evidence to surface emerging issues and identify opportunities before they become delivery requests.
- Created a reusable cross-platform parity framework across six product domains, replacing identical-interface thinking with consistent concepts and context-appropriate differences.
- Defined the purpose of Portfolio Overview, the platform’s primary post-login landing page, using foundational research to create product guardrails for what belonged on the surface and prevent feature accumulation.
- Reframed SIPP account opening from conversion optimisation to comprehension and decision confidence, shifting focus from shortening the journey to making unavoidable pension complexity easier to act on.
- Identified W-8BEN as a barrier to US trading access, shaping a substantially simpler responsive journey. Completion subsequently increased by 22 percentage points, with wider commercial impact kept explicitly shared.
- Defined which research tasks could be delegated to AI and where specialist UXR accountability had to remain, creating a governed AI-assisted workflow for scaling lower-risk evaluative research without weakening quality.

UI Centric | Senior User Experience Researcher (Freelance)

June 2023 - August 2023 · Oddschecker

- Shifted Oddschecker's US proposition from an odds-led comparison towards bonuses and promotions after research showed these were more salient to the target audience; secured stakeholder alignment and supported delivery of a tailored NFL-season MVP within two months.
- Established an internal research capability while leading concurrent client work, broadening UI Centric's service offering and creating a stronger basis for research-led new business.

AND Digital | Senior User Experience Researcher (Permanent)

August 2022 - May 2023 · Costa Coffee, Edenred, PlayStation, RS Components

- Led research across international B2B and B2C engagements, shaping approaches, assuring the quality of internal and client-side junior teams' work, and influencing stakeholders across differing levels of seniority and UX maturity.
- For Edenred, led the research strategy for a B2B2C platform redesign, shifting the programme from a broad interface refresh towards a product direction grounded in how different employees understand and value benefits. Established principles for information architecture and need-based personalisation that guided navigation, content and homepage decisions across the multidisciplinary team.
- As the first UX researcher in the AND Digital business studio, established research capability through tooling, participant access, training for developers, designers and product owners, and mentoring of junior researchers.

Citizens Advice | UX Researcher

October 2019 - August 2022

- Led research strategy for a national intranet transformation serving 30,000 staff and volunteers, working with senior Product, Design, Content and Engineering colleagues to align multiple workstreams from discovery through launch. Defined user needs, information-architecture direction and success measures for replacing two legacy systems and approximately 7,000 pages; post-launch reporting showed 90% user success.
- Led organisation-wide research into Casebook data collection, making the trade-off between demographic completeness and adviser capacity explicit and aligning service heads around service changes. Changes informed by the work were followed by a 30% increase in QA passes and a 25% reduction in average collection time.
- Extended research leadership beyond individual projects by setting measurement guidance, overseeing junior workstreams and building inclusive recruitment routes with community leaders for sensitive research.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

UserZoom | UX Researcher

January 2019 - October 2019

- Led parallel financial-services and ecommerce programmes for Bose, OpenMoney and Money Advice Service, combining behavioural evidence with task success, confidence and time measures to guide prioritisation.

Ipsos MORI | UX Consultant (Contract)

September 2018 - October 2018 · Visa, American Express

- Led discovery, RITE and remote evaluation for credit and onboarding propositions, exposing comprehension and application-anxiety risks beneath positive usability scores.

Spotless | User Experience Consultant

May 2016 - August 2018

- Planned UK research and synthesised evidence across France and the US for Facebook Messenger; conducted foundational Oculus research into interaction complexity and onboarding confidence.
- Challenged premature solution validation for AXA/KAMET and redirected the engagement to contextual discovery with 36 fleet managers, producing personas, journeys and opportunity areas for senior client decision-makers.

University College London / BBC | Cognitive Research Engineer

September 2013 - May 2016

- Led contextual inquiry and cognitive work analysis in BBC broadcast control rooms, defining information requirements for proactive routing decisions and contributing to peer-reviewed research.

EDUCATION AND PUBLICATIONS

MRes, Virtual Environments, Imaging and Visualisation - UCL

MSc, Human-Computer Interaction with Ergonomics - UCL

BSc, Psychology

Published through Springer, ACM and SAGE on ecological interface design, proactive decision-making and visual perception.